



Cognitive Psychology (COGPSY)

Module 5: Motivation, Emotion and Perception

Perception

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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What Is Perception?

Sensation is raw input from the senses. Perception is the organised, meaningful experience built from that input. Two people can receive similar sensory input and perceive different meanings depending on expectation, culture, and attention.

How We Construct What We See

The brain uses bottom-up information from the senses and top-down knowledge from expectations and past experience. That is why a partially hidden boda in traffic can still be recognised quickly if you are used to Kampala roads. Illusions show that perception is constructed, not a perfect copy of the world.

Perception in Daily Life

In class, you may miss a slide detail if attention is on your phone. In a clinic or community setting, expectations can shape what a practitioner notices first. Being aware of perception helps you slow down and check what you might have missed.

Reflect: Give one example from campus where expectation changed what you noticed first.

Closing

Module 5 is complete. Module 6 covers moral cognition, AI, and the future of the field.